DSC 210, Fall 2026 — Homework 1 Nicholas Wendt (200478549)

Question 1: Property of triangular matrices (20 points)

Given U_1 and U_2 are two upper triangular matrices of size $n \times n$, prove that U_1U_2 is also an upper triangular matrix. Further, prove by induction that multiplication of $m\,(m > 2)$ upper triangular matrices $(U_1, U_2, \ldots, U_m)$ is also an upper triangular matrix.

Solution:

Since both U_1 and U_2 are upper triangular matrices that means entries $a_{ij} = 0$ for $i > j$ in U_1 and entries $b_{ij} = 0$ for $i > j$ in U_2.
Let matrix $C = U_1U_2$. We want to show that entries $c_{ij} = 0$ when $i > j$.
The element

$$c_{ij} = \sum_{k=1}^{n} a_{ik}b_{kj} = a_{i1}b_{1j} + a_{i2}b_{2j} + \cdots + a_{in}b_{nj}$$

To show that every term in this sum is 0, we look at 2 cases.
Case 1: Let $k < i$, then element $a_{ik} = 0$
Case 2: Let $k \geq i$, then $k \geq i > j$, so $k > j$. Then element $b_{kj} = 0$
So $\forall k$, $a_{ik}b_{kj} = 0$

Therefore $c_{ij} = 0$ for $i > j$ making C an upper triangular matrix. □

Inductive step: Assume $P_m = U_1U_2 \cdots U_m$ is an upper triangular matrix.
Let U_{m+1} be an upper triangular $n \times n$ matrix. Since matrix multiplication is associative,

$$P_{m+1} = U_1U_2 \cdots U_mU_{m+1} = (U_1U_2 \cdots U_m)\,U_{m+1} = P_m\,U_{m+1}.$$

By the inductive hypothesis, P_m is upper triangular, and U_{m+1} is upper triangular by definition. By the base case, the product of two upper triangular matrices is upper triangular.

So P_mU_{m+1} is upper triangular. Therefore P_{m+1} is upper triangular.

Conclusion: By induction, the product $U_1U_2 \cdots U_m$ of upper triangular matrices is an upper triangular matrix for all $m \geq 2$. □

Question 2: Matrix operations (20 points)

Let $\mathbf{B}$ be a 4×4 matrix to which we apply the following 7 operations sequentially and get a final matrix $\mathbf{D}$:

(i) triple column 2,

(ii) halve row 4,

(iii) add row 2 to row 1,

(iv) interchange columns 1 and 3,

(v) subtract row 3 from each of the other rows,

(vi) replace column 4 by column 2,

(vii) delete column 1 (so that the column dimension is reduced by 1).

(a) Express each operation (i) to (vii) as a matrix and the final matrix $\mathbf{D}$ as a product of 8 matrices. (10 points)

(b) Write the final result again as a product of $\mathbf{ABC}$, i.e. write matrix $\mathbf{D} = \mathbf{ABC}$ and find $\mathbf{A}, \mathbf{C}$. (5 points)

(c) Write Python code to verify your answers in parts a and b. Show the answers and code. (5 points) Let

$$\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 & 0 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 & 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Hint: You can use NumPy for matrix operations.

Solution:
(a)
(b)
(c)

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import numpy as np
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Question 3: Matrix properties (20 points)

Prove that if a matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is triangular (upper or lower) then $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ is also triangular. Further, use the result to show that if $\mathbf{A}$ is both triangular and orthogonal, then it is diagonal.

Solution:

Question 4: p-norm inequalities (20 points)

Let $\mathbf{x}$ be a real m-vector. The vector p-norms $\|\mathbf{x}\|_p$ are related by various inequalities, often involving the dimension of the vector, i.e. m. For parts (a) and (b), prove the inequality and give an example of a nonzero vector $\mathbf{x}$ for which *equality* is satisfied.

(a) $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 \leq \|\mathbf{x}\|_1$. (7 points)

(b) $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 \leq \sqrt{m} \cdot \|\mathbf{x}\|_\infty$. (7 points)

(c) Plot a 2D contour of $\|\mathbf{x}\|_1 = 1$; on the same chart also highlight regions where $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 < 1$, $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 = 1$ and $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 > 1$. Describe where the contour intersects $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 = 1$. (6 points)

Solution:
(a)
(b)
(c)

Question 5: Basic vector operations (20 points)

Given two 3-dimensional vectors $\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b}$, and three matrices $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{3\times 2}$, $\mathbf{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{2\times 3}$, $\mathbf{C} \in \mathbb{R}^{3\times 2}$, and scalars β_1, β_2 with the values below:

$$\mathbf{a} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 5 \\ 9 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 6 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 \\ 2 & 5 \\ 3 & 6 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \beta_1 = 2,\ \beta_2 = 3$$

(a) Compute the following operations by hand and show your work. If an operation is undefined, state why. (15 points)

(i) Vector operations: $\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{b}$, $\beta_1 \mathbf{a}$, $\mathbf{a} \circ \mathbf{b}$, $\beta_1 \mathbf{a} + \beta_2 \mathbf{b}$, where $\circ$ denotes component-wise multiplication. (3 points)

(ii) Matrix operations: $\beta_1 \mathbf{A}$, $\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}$, $\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{C}$. (3 points)

(iii) Transpose operations: $(\mathbf{BA})^\top$, $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{B}^\top$, $(\mathbf{A}^\top)^\top$, $(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{C})^\top$. (3 points)

(iv) Inner products and outer product: $\langle \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b} \rangle$, $\langle \mathbf{b}, \mathbf{a} \rangle$, $\langle \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{a} \rangle$, $\langle \mathbf{b}, \mathbf{b} \rangle$, $\beta_1 \langle \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b} \rangle$, $\langle \beta_1 \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b} \rangle$, $\mathbf{b}\mathbf{a}^\top$. (3 points)

(v) Determinants: $\det(\mathbf{BA})$, $\det(\mathbf{CB})$. (3 points)

(b) Implement all the parts above using Python and show the answers and code. (5 points)

Solution:
(a)
(b)

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import numpy as np
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